

THE GEMPEI WARS

The wars fought in medieval Japan between the rival Minamoto and Taira clans became the subject of a popular epic sung by blind musicians. In this detail from a screen that shows the last great battles, the Taira ships are being attacked by the mounted warriors of Minamoto at Yashima in March 1185. The Taira managed to escape their pursuers for a time, but were defeated at the decisive naval battle of Dan-no-Ura in April 1185.